Modulo

Modulo User Guide

TABLE OF CONTENTS

1 ABOUT MODULO 4
1.1 Who Should Read This Guide 4
1.2 What is Modulo? 4
1.3 What Modulo is NOT 4
1.4 The Problem Modulo Solves 4
1.5 What is a Master Document? 5
1.6 How Modulo Works 5
1.7 Who is Modulo For? 5
1.8 Key Benefits 6
1.9 How Modulo is Different 6
2 PREPARING YOUR MASTER DOCUMENT 8
2.1 Understanding Outline Levels 8
2.1.1 Using Word's Built-in Heading Styles (Recommended) 8
2.1.2 Creating Custom Styles with Outline Levels 8
2.1.3 Advanced: Granular Selection with Outline Levels 10
2.1.4 Common Problem: "Junk Headings" 11
2.2 Document Structure Basics 12
2.2.1 Cover Pages and Front Matter 12
2.2.2 Page Formatting 12
2.3 Headers and Footers 12
2.4 Section Breaks 12
2.5 Tables and Outline Levels 13
2.6 Heading Notes and Duplicate Names 13
3 GETTING STARTED 15
4 UNDERSTANDING THE MODULO INTERFACE 16
4.1 Section Selection Tab 16
4.1.1 Loading Your Master Document 17
4.1.2 Selection Controls 18
4.1.3 Working with Presets 18
4.1.4 Generating Your Document 19
4.2 Custom Fields Tab 20
4.2.1 How Custom Fields Work 20
4.2.2 User Input Fields 21
4.2.3 Auto-Formatting for Currency and Percentages 21
4.2.4 Calculated Fields 22
4.2.5 Field Validation and Warnings 23
4.2.6 Optional Fields 23
4.2.7 Clear All 23
4.3 Presets Tab 24
4.3.1 Preset Management Controls 24
4.3.2 Preset Tables 25
4.4 Settings Tab 26
4.4.1 Startup 27
4.4.2 Selection Behaviour 27
4.4.3 Document Generation 27
4.4.4 Preset Configuration 27
4.4.5 Cache Management 28

4.4.6 License ... 28
4.5 Help Tab ... 29
4.5.1 Resources ... 29
4.5.2 Example Document ... 29
4.5.3 Contact Us ... 30
4.5.4 Website ... 30
4.5.5 About ... 30
5 WORKING WITH PRESETS ... 31
5.1 Preset Modes: Shared vs Local ... 31
5.1.1 Understanding Preset Modes ... 31
5.1.2 The Team Workflow: Admin and Read-Only Users ... 31
5.1.3 Updating the Master Document ... 32
5.2 Setting Up Shared Preset Libraries ... 33
5.2.1 Initial Setup: Creating the First Admin ... 33
5.2.2 Configuring the Shared Preset Location ... 34
5.2.3 Linking a New Computer to the Shared Library ... 34
5.2.4 When to Use Each Mode ... 35
5.3 Creating and Managing Presets ... 36
5.3.1 Understanding Preset Selection States ... 36
5.3.2 Creating a New Preset ... 37
5.3.3 Loading a Preset ... 40
5.3.4 Updating an Existing Preset ... 41
5.3.5 Best Practices for Preset Design ... 41
5.4 Handling Master Document Changes: Renumbering and Missing Headings ... 42
5.4.1 Automatic Change Detection ... 42
5.4.2 Renumbered Headings (Orange/Yellow) ... 43
5.4.3 Numbering Style Compatibility ... 44
5.4.4 Quick Update Preset ... 45
5.4.5 After Quick Update ... 46
5.4.6 Missing or Renamed Headings (Red) ... 47
5.4.7 Fixing Missing Headings ... 48
5.4.8 Best Practices ... 48
6 CUSTOM FIELD FORMULAS ... 49
6.1 Formula Syntax Basics ... 49
6.2 Arithmetic Operators ... 49
6.3 Mathematical Functions ... 50
6.4 Common Formula Examples ... 51
6.5 Formula Errors and Warnings ... 52
6.6 Testing Your Formulas ... 53
7 TROUBLESHOOTING ... 54
7.1 Basic Troubleshooting Steps ... 54
7.1.1 Clear Document Cache ... 54
7.1.2 Isolate Problematic Sections ... 54
7.2 Getting Help ... 55
8 THANK YOU ... 56

1 ABOUT MODULO

1.1 Who Should Read This Guide

This User Guide is primarily written for **Master Document Administrators** - the person responsible for maintaining the master document and managing shared presets.

If you are a Read-Only User (someone who loads and uses presets created by your administrator), you may only need to read:

- **Section 1:** About Modulo (understanding what Modulo does)
- **Section 4:** Understanding the Modulo Interface (how to use the application)
- **Section 7:** Troubleshooting (if you encounter issues)

Sections 2, 5 and 6 cover preset creation, management, and advanced features that are primarily relevant to administrators who create and maintain shared presets for their teams.

1.2 What is Modulo?

Modulo is document automation software that helps professionals create custom documents in minutes instead of hours. Instead of manually copying, pasting, and deleting sections from old documents or wrestling with messy templates, Modulo lets you select the sections you need, click a button, and instantly generate a clean document tailored to your needs.

1.3 What Modulo is NOT

Modulo does not use AI, does not write content for you, and does not guess what you need. It is a precise tool that assembles documents based on your explicit selections. The content comes from you - Modulo just handles the tedious assembly work.

1.4 The Problem Modulo Solves

Many professionals create documents that follow similar structures but vary in content based on the specific situation. The traditional approach involves either:

- Copying an old document and deleting irrelevant sections (risking errors, outdated information, and inconsistent formatting)
- Maintaining multiple templates for different scenarios (leading to version control nightmares and duplicate content)
- Starting from scratch each time (wasting hours on document structure instead of actual content)

This process is tedious, error-prone, and wastes valuable time. Critical sections get forgotten, outdated content gets left in, and hours are spent on formatting and document assembly rather than actual productive work.

1.5 What is a Master Document?

A Master Document is the foundation of Modulo. It is a single, comprehensive Word document that contains every possible section, chapter, and piece of content your organization might use across all your documents.

Think of it as a library of all your standardized content in one place. For example, an organization might have sections for:

- Executive summaries and introductions
- Standard descriptions and methodologies
- Analysis sections and findings
- Recommendations and next steps
- Standard terms, conditions, and disclaimers
- Appendices and supporting information

Instead of maintaining multiple template files, you maintain one Master Document. When you need to create a new document, Modulo reads this master, lets you select which sections are relevant to your current situation, and assembles a clean, properly formatted document containing only what you need.

1.6 How Modulo Works

1. Load your Master Document into Modulo

2. Load a preset to automatically select your standard sections, or manually select sections by checking boxes

3. Click "Generate Document"

4. Modulo creates a new Word document containing only your selected sections, with properly updated table of contents, heading numbers, and formatting

The entire process takes minutes, not hours. No copy-pasting, no manual deletion, no formatting headaches.

1.7 Who is Modulo For?

Modulo is designed for any professional or organization that regularly creates documents with modular, reusable content. This includes:

- Consulting firms (engineering, management, financial, environmental)
- Professional services (legal, accounting, auditing)
- Proposal and RFP response teams
- HR departments creating policies and documentation
- Construction and project management
- Academic and research institutions
- Any organization producing structured reports, contracts, or deliverables

If you find yourself repeatedly creating similar documents with variations in content, Modulo can help.

1.8 Key Benefits

Significant Time Savings

Modulo dramatically reduces the time spent on document assembly, initial setup, review, and revisions. This frees up more time for actual productive work and billable activities.

Consistency and Quality

Every document starts from the same master, ensuring consistent professional quality across all deliverables. You will never forget to include relevant sections, and documents feel more comprehensive without extra effort.

Institutional Knowledge Capture

Your Master Document becomes a living repository of your organization's expertise. Every document adds refinements that benefit all future work. Senior expertise gets preserved, knowledge compounds over time, and institutional knowledge remains even when people leave.

Centralized Control

Maintain one master document instead of multiple scattered templates. Update content, compliance notes, and standard language once - every future document is instantly correct. No template drift, no version control nightmares.

Easier Training and Onboarding

New team members learn proper document structure immediately. Presets teach what complete documents should look like, and staff can produce consistent, professional output quickly.

Reduced Mental Load

Eliminate the constant "did I include everything?" anxiety. No decision fatigue about document structure. Focus entirely on content, not administrative overhead.

1.9 How Modulo is Different

Modulo is built for professionals who work in Word and need a simple solution. Unlike complex enterprise document automation systems that require weeks of setup, programming knowledge, and extensive training:

- Modulo works with your existing Word documents - no migration, no rebuilding from scratch
- Setup takes hours, not weeks - most users are productive on day one

- No programming or technical knowledge required - if you can use Word, you can use Modulo
- Visual checkbox selection instead of question-based interviews
- Desktop application - your documents never leave your computer
- Designed for document assembly, not form-filling with variables

2 PREPARING YOUR MASTER DOCUMENT

Your Master Document is the foundation of Modulo. Properly structuring it ensures Modulo can accurately detect and assemble your sections. This chapter covers the essential requirements and best practices for preparing your master document.

Important: Modulo's power comes from your document structure. Spending time here will save you hours later.

2.1 Understanding Outline Levels

Modulo detects sections in your Master Document by reading **outline** levels. In Microsoft Word, outline levels are a hierarchical structure that defines how content is organized. Anything with an outline level assigned will appear as a selectable section in Modulo.

2.1.1 Using Word's Built-in Heading Styles (Recommended)

The simplest and most reliable way to structure your Master Document is to use Word's built-in heading styles: Heading 1, Heading 2, Heading 3, and so on. These styles automatically have outline levels assigned:

Heading 1 = Outline Level 1

Heading 2 = Outline Level 2

Heading 3 = Outline Level 3

And so on...

Using these built-in styles ensures compatibility with Modulo and makes your document structure clear and consistent.

2.1.2 Creating Custom Styles with Outline Levels

If you need custom formatting that differs from the built-in heading styles (for example, "Appendix X" where X updates automatically), you can create a custom style and assign it an outline level.

To assign an outline level to a custom style:

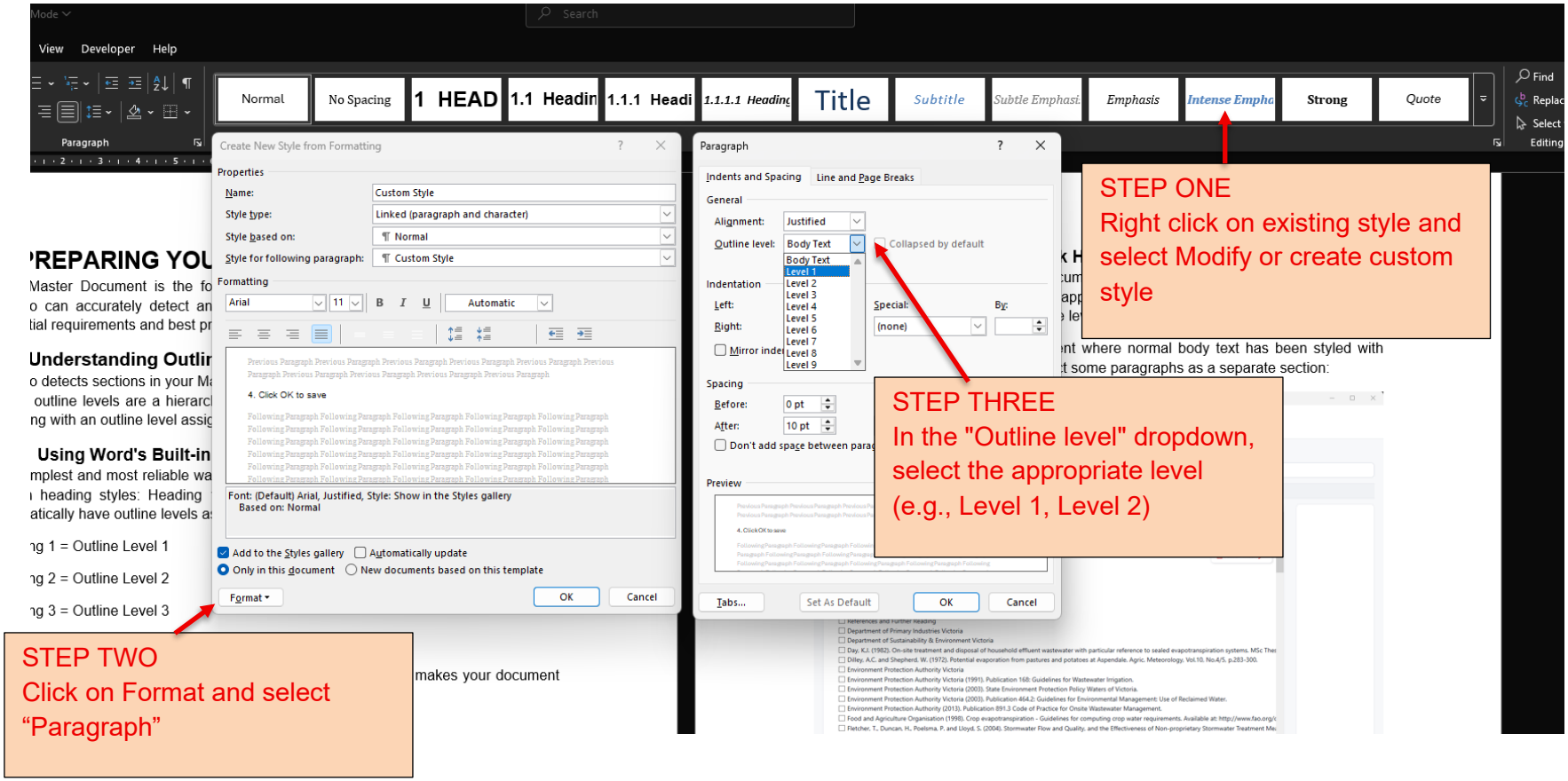
1. Right-click your custom style in the Styles pane and select "Modify"

2. Click "Format" → "Paragraph"

3. In the "Outline level" dropdown, select the appropriate level (e.g., Level 1, Level 2)

4. Click OK to save

The following page illustrates how to set outline levels on custom styles within Word.


STEP ONE
Right click on existing style and select Modify or create custom style
STEP THREE
In the "Outline level" dropdown, select the appropriate level (e.g., Level 1, Level 2)
STEP TWO
Click on Format and select "Paragraph"

2.1.3 Advanced: Granular Selection with Outline Levels

For advanced users, Modulo supports selection at a very granular level - down to individual paragraphs or bullet points. This is achieved by assigning outline levels to content that would normally be considered "body text."

Use Case: Selectable Bullet Points

A common application of this feature is creating selectable scope items, requirements, or tasks. For example, under a heading like "Field Investigation and Testing," you might have dozens of individual tasks as bullet points. By assigning an outline level (such as Outline Level 9) to each bullet point, you can select or deselect individual tasks in Modulo rather than including or excluding the entire section.

How to Set This Up

Create a custom paragraph style for your selectable items (e.g., "Scope Item" or "Task Item") and assign it an outline level following the instructions in section 2.1.2. Apply this style to each paragraph or bullet point you want to be independently selectable.

Critical Consideration: Content Ownership

When using granular outline levels, it is essential to understand how Modulo handles content between outline-level items. Any content that appears after an outline-level item and before the next outline-level item belongs to that first item.

For example:

- Task A (Outline Level 9)
- Task B (Outline Level 9)

[Normal paragraph explaining Task B in detail]

[Another normal paragraph with additional notes]

- Task C (Outline Level 9)

In this structure:

- If you deselect Task B, both explanatory paragraphs are also removed (they belong to Task B)
- If you deselect Task C, any content after it (until the next outline level) is also removed

This behaviour ensures that explanatory text, tables, or images associated with a specific item are kept together. However, it requires careful document structuring to avoid unintentionally deleting content.

Best Practice

If you use granular selection with outline levels, ensure that all related content (explanations, notes, tables) appears immediately after the relevant item and before the next outline-level item. Test your selections in Modulo to verify content is grouped as intended.

2.1.4 Common Problem: "Junk Headings"

When you first load your master document you may see many unexpected sections appearing in Modulo. This typically happens when normal text in your document has been accidentally styled with an outline level.

The example below shows a document where normal body text has been styled with outline levels, causing Modulo to detect some paragraphs as a separate section:

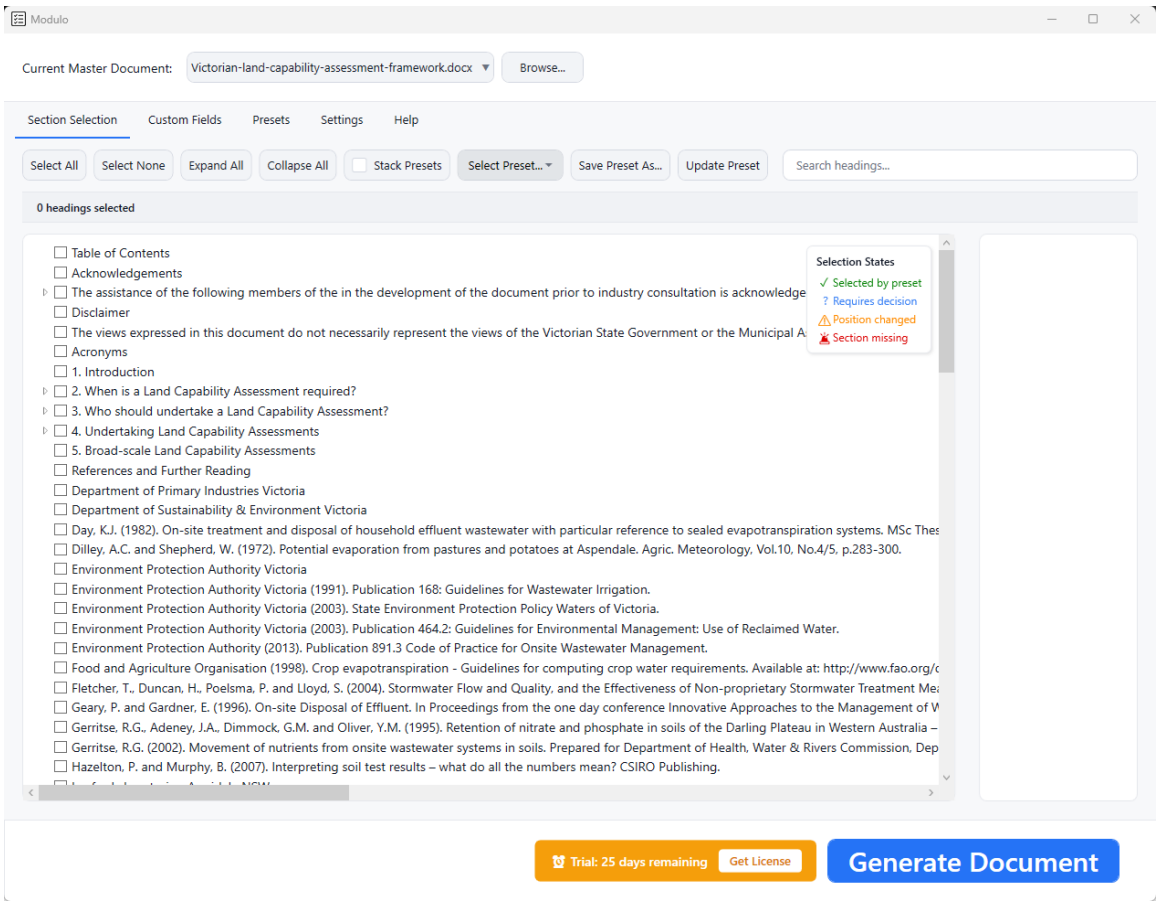


Figure 2-1 Example of Poorly Formatted Document Within Modulo

Note: Badly formatted documents like this will still work in Modulo, but they make section selection difficult and time-consuming. It is worth investing time to properly structure your Master Document with clean outline levels.

2.2 Document Structure Basics

2.2.1 Cover Pages and Front Matter

Modulo preserves everything that appears before your first outline level. This means your cover pages, title pages, table of contents, and any other front matter will remain intact in every generated document. No special setup is required - simply ensure this content appears before your first section heading.

2.2.2 Page Formatting

Modulo retains all your document formatting, including:

Landscape and portrait page orientations

Custom paper sizes (A3, A4, Letter, etc.)

Margins and spacing

Fonts, colors, and styles

Your generated documents will maintain the exact formatting you have defined in your Master Document.

2.3 Headers and Footers

Best Practice: Do NOT use "Link to Previous" in your headers and footers.

When you use "Link to Previous" in Word's header and footer sections, headers and footers from one section carry over into subsequent sections. This can cause formatting issues in your generated documents, where headers or footers from deleted sections may inadvertently appear in your final output.

To ensure each section's headers and footers remain independent, uncheck "Link to Previous" for each section in your Master Document. This prevents unwanted header and footer carryover in generated documents.

2.4 Section Breaks

Section breaks in Word allow you to change page formatting, headers, footers, and page numbering within a single document. Modulo works best with specific types of section breaks:

Use: Next Page, Even Page, or Odd Page section breaks

These section breaks create a clear separation between sections and ensure formatting remains contained within each section.

Avoid: Continuous section breaks

Continuous section breaks allow formatting changes without starting a new page. While Modulo will still generate documents with continuous section breaks, they can

sometimes cause format bleeding, where formatting from one section carries over into adjacent sections in unintended ways.

If you must use continuous section breaks for your document layout, test your generated documents carefully to ensure formatting appears as expected.

2.5 Tables and Outline Levels

Important Limitation: Modulo cannot detect outline levels within table cells.

If you assign an outline level to text inside a table cell, Modulo will not recognize it as a section. This means you cannot structure your document sections inside tables.

Tables themselves work perfectly fine in Modulo - they will be included or excluded along with the sections they belong to. The limitation is only that section headings (text with outline levels) cannot be placed inside table cells.

2.6 Heading Notes and Duplicate Names

Modulo supports a special syntax that allows you to add notes or tags to headings that will be displayed in Modulo's interface but removed from the generated document. This is useful when you have variations of the same section that apply in different scenarios.

The [[Note]] Syntax

Any text enclosed in double square brackets [[note]] will be displayed in Modulo's interface but removed from the generated document. The [[note]] can appear anywhere in the heading text.

Format: [[Note]] anywhere in your heading

Example Use Cases

Differentiating Duplicate Section Names:

4.2 [[Rock Encountered]]Presence of Rock

4.3 [[Rock Not Encountered]]Presence of Rock

Adding Context Tags:

5.1 Foundation Design [[Residential]]

5.2 Foundation Design [[Commercial]]

In Modulo's Interface:

- You see distinct sections with their tags: "[[Rock Encountered]]Presence of Rock" and "[[Rock Not Encountered]]Presence of Rock"
- You can clearly identify which version to include in your document

In Your Generated Document:

- The tags are completely removed
- Headings appear as simply "Presence of Rock" (with appropriate numbering)

Important Notes:

- The [[note]] can appear anywhere in the heading - beginning, middle, or end
- You can use multiple [[notes]] in a single heading if needed
- The double square brackets must be closed: [[and]]
- This works with any outline level (Heading 1, Heading 2, custom styles, etc.)
- Use whatever text inside the brackets helps you differentiate sections

This feature allows you to maintain multiple variations of similarly-named sections in your master document without confusing end users who see the final generated documents.

3 GETTING STARTED

For installation, activation, and generating your first document, please refer to the **Modulo Quick Start Guide**.

This User Guide focuses on advanced features and detailed explanations for regular Modulo users.

4 UNDERSTANDING THE MODULO INTERFACE

This section provides an overview of Modulo's interface and explains the function of each button and tab. Detailed explanations of presets and custom fields are covered in later sections.

4.1 Section Selection Tab

The Section Selection tab is where you select which sections to include in your generated document. This is Modulo's primary workspace.

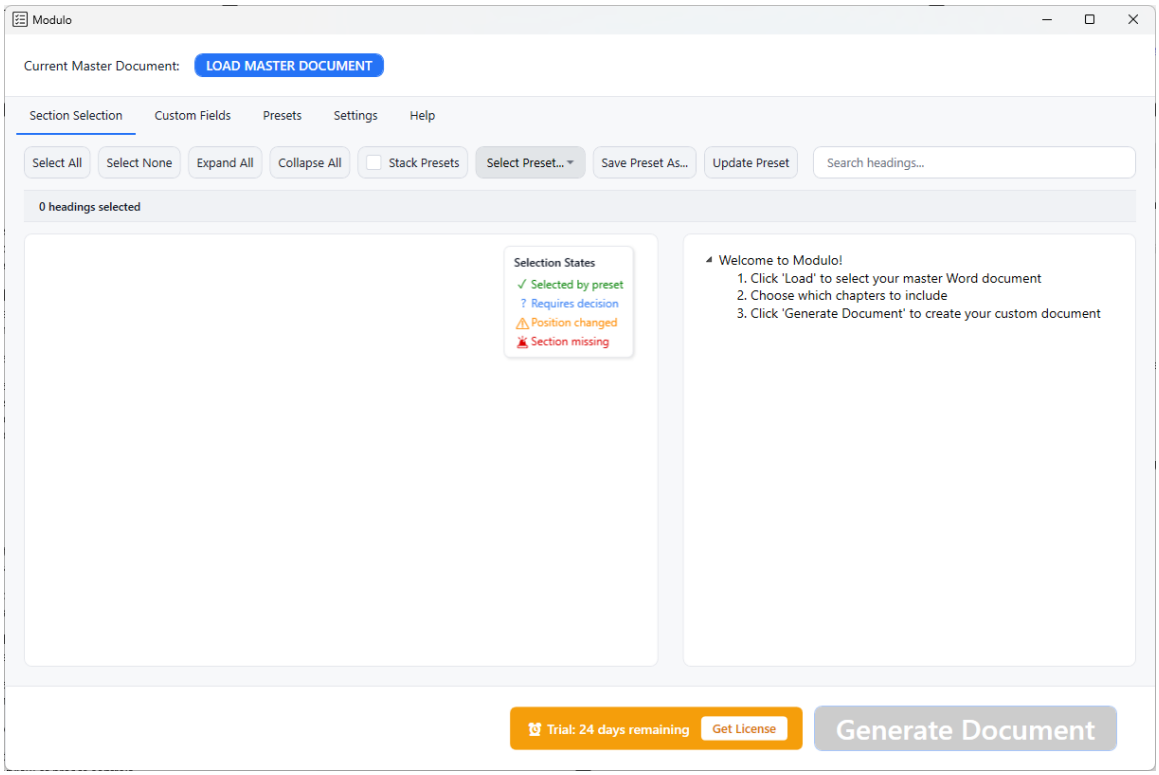


Figure 4-1 Modulo Section Selection Tab

4.1.1 Loading Your Master Document

Load Master Document / Browse - When you first open Modulo, click "Load Master Document" to select your master Word document. After loading your first master, this button changes to "Browse," which allows you to switch to a different master document. The dropdown next to the Browse button shows your currently loaded master and allows you to quickly switch between recently used masters. Modulo automatically loads your last-used master document when you reopen the application.

Interface Layout

Once your master document is loaded, the Section Selection tab displays two panels:

Left Panel - Section Selection Tree. This panel shows your complete document structure with checkboxes for each section. Check the boxes to select which sections to include in your generated document. The tree view displays the hierarchical structure of your master document, showing parent sections and their child subsections.

Right Panel - Document Preview. This panel shows a preview of your generated document's contents based on your current selections. As you select or deselect sections on the left, the preview updates in real-time to show exactly what will appear in your final document. This allows you to verify your selections before generating.

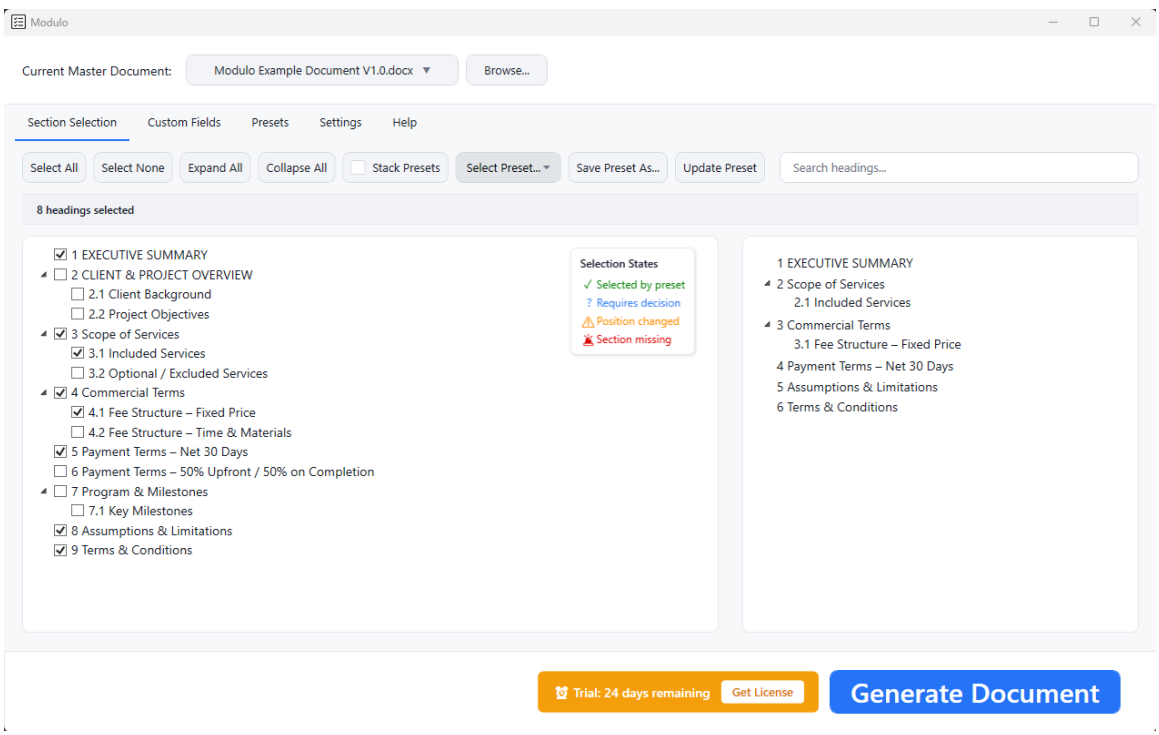


Figure 4-2 Modulo with an Example Document and Some Sections Selected

4.1.2 Selection Controls

By default, clicking a section selects that section and all its child subsections. To select only a single section without its children, hold Ctrl while clicking. This behaviour can be reversed in the Settings tab (see Section 4.4) so that normal clicks select only the clicked section, and Ctrl+click selects the section and all children.

Select All - Selects all sections in your master document. Useful when you want to include everything and then deselect a few specific sections.

Select None - Deselects all sections and clears all loaded presets. This acts as a "reset" button, returning the interface to a clean state as if you just loaded the document. Use this when you want to start fresh with a new selection.

Expand All - Expands all sections to show their child subsections. This makes it easier to see the complete structure of your document and select specific subsections.

Collapse All - Collapses all sections to show only top-level headings. This provides a cleaner view when working with large documents with many nested subsections.

Search Headings - Opens a search box that allows you to quickly find sections by name. Particularly useful in master documents with hundreds of sections.

4.1.3 Working with Presets

Note: Presets are covered in detail in Section 5. This section provides a brief overview of preset controls.

Stack Presets (checkbox) - Controls how multiple presets are applied:

- **Unchecked (default):** Loading a new preset clears the previous preset. If you load Preset A, then load Preset B, only Preset B's selections remain.
- **Checked:** Presets are additive. Loading Preset A, then Preset B applies both presets' selections together. Useful for combining common section groups.

Select Preset... (dropdown) - Displays a list of all your saved presets. Select a preset from this list to instantly apply its section selections.

Save Preset As... - Saves your current section selections as a new preset. You will be prompted to name the preset.

Update Preset - If you have loaded a preset and made changes to the selections, clicking this button updates the loaded preset with your new selections.

4.1.4 Generating Your Document

Generate Document - Creates your custom Word document based on your selected sections. When clicked, Modulo will:

1. Prompt you to choose a save location
2. Generate the document (you will see a progress indicator)
3. Automatically open the generated document in Microsoft Word when complete

4.2 Custom Fields Tab

The Custom Fields tab allows you to create placeholders in your master document that are automatically replaced with project-specific information when you generate a document. This is Modulo's find-and-replace feature, but with built-in support for calculations and auto-formatting.

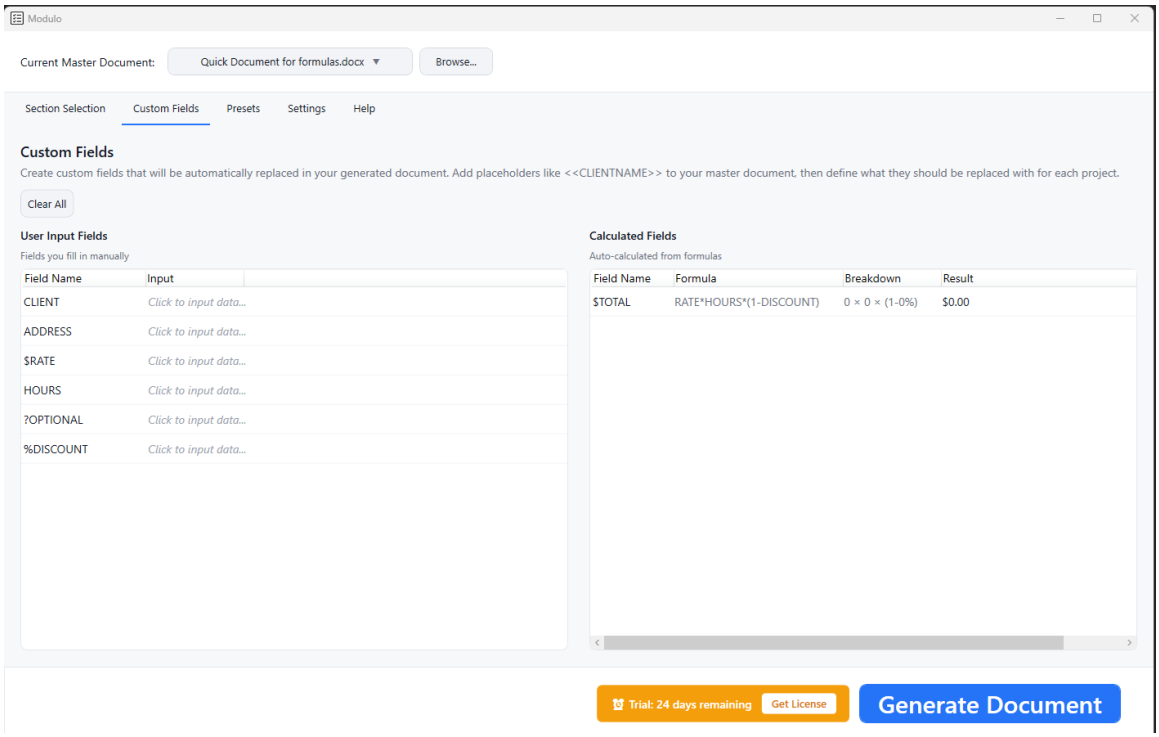


Figure 4-3 Modulo Custom Fields Tab

4.2.1 How Custom Fields Work

Custom fields are created by adding placeholders to your master document using double angle brackets: <<PLACEHOLDER>>. When you load your master document, Modulo automatically detects all placeholders and displays them in the Custom Fields tab.

Important: Modulo only displays placeholders that exist in your currently selected sections. If a placeholder appears in a section you have not selected, it will not appear in the Custom Fields tab. This ensures you only fill in fields that are actually relevant to your current document, rather than seeing every placeholder from your entire master document.

For example, if your master document contains <<CLIENTNAME>>, <<ADDRESS>>, and <<$RATE>>, these will only appear in the Custom Fields tab if the sections containing these placeholders are selected. As you select or deselect sections, the Custom Fields list updates automatically..

4.2.2 User Input Fields

User Input Fields are placeholders you fill in manually for each document. Common examples include client names, addresses, dates, project numbers, and other project-specific information.

To create a user input field, simply add the placeholder to your master document: <<FIELDNAME>>

4.2.3 Auto-Formatting for Currency and Percentages

If your placeholder name starts with $ or %, Modulo automatically formats the value:

- <<$RATE>> - Formats as currency (e.g., $200.00)
- <<%DISCOUNT>> - Formats as percentage (e.g., 10%)

4.2.4 Calculated Fields

Calculated Fields use formulas to automatically compute values based on other fields. Formulas use Excel-like syntax and support basic mathematical operations (+, -, *, /) as well as more advanced calculations.

To create a calculated field, use the format: <<$FIELDNAME=FORMULA>>

For example:

- <<$TOTAL=RATE*HOURS*(1-DISCOUNT)>>

As shown in the screenshots, this formula multiplies RATE × HOURS × (1 - DISCOUNT) to calculate the total. When you change any input value (RATE, HOURS, or DISCOUNT), the TOTAL automatically recalculates and displays the result.

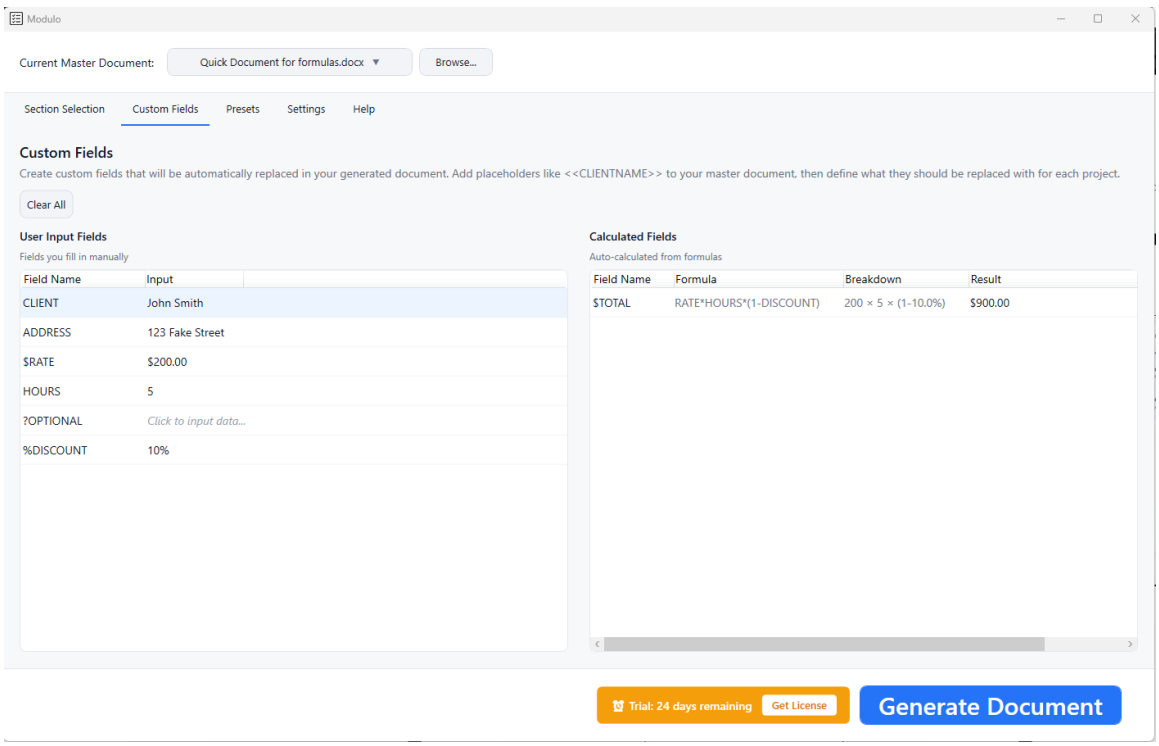


Figure 4-4 Modulo with Custom Fields Populated

Formula Notes:

- Most basic calculator operations work reliably
- More advanced mathematical functions may or may not be supported - test your specific formula to verify
- The "Breakdown" column shows how the formula was evaluated, helping you verify calculations

4.2.5 Field Validation and Warnings

Modulo warns you if:

- Any required field is left empty
- Any formula produces an error

These warnings appear before you generate your document, preventing incomplete or broken outputs.

4.2.6 Optional Fields

If a placeholder includes a question mark (<<?OPTIONAL>>), Modulo treats it as optional and will not warn you if the field is left empty. This is useful for fields that may not apply to every project.

4.2.7 Clear All

The "Clear All" button resets all custom field inputs to their default empty state. Use this when starting a new project to ensure no previous project's data carries over.

Note: Custom fields are covered in detail in Section 6 of this guide.

4.3 Presets Tab

The Presets tab is where you manage your saved section selections (presets). This tab allows you to import, export, organize, and track usage of both your personal presets and shared team presets.

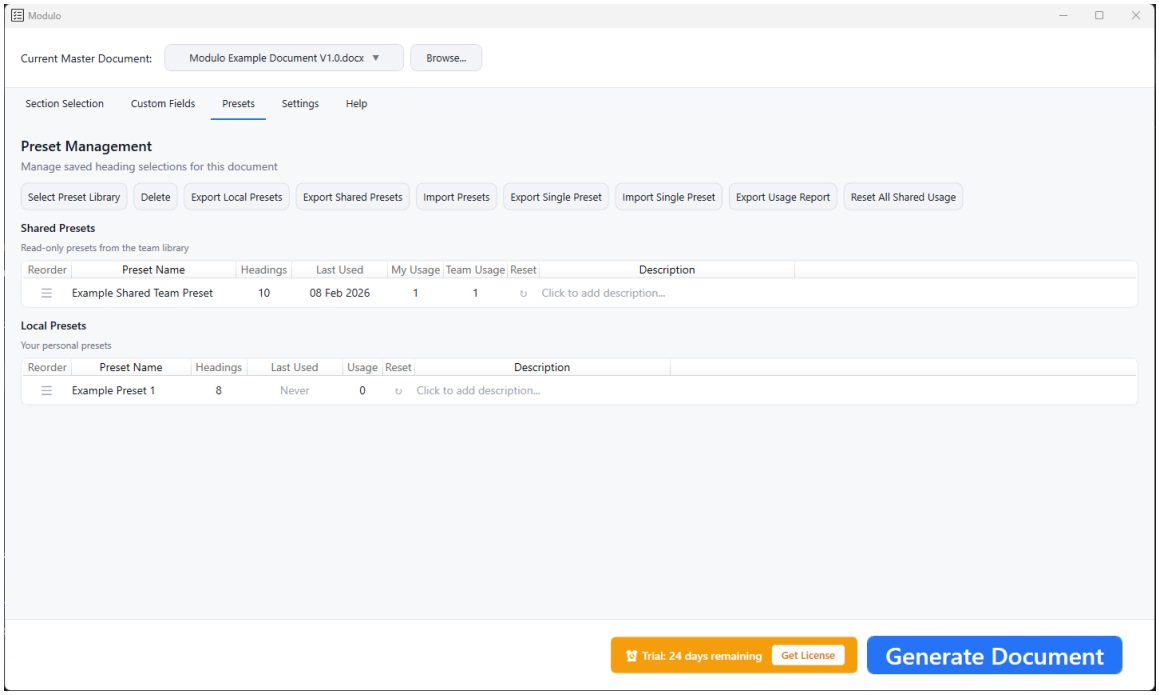


Figure 4-5 Modulo Preset Tab

4.3.1 Preset Management Controls

Select Preset Library - Relinks your preset library to the current master document. This is useful if you rename your master document or need to associate presets with a different master file.

Delete - Deletes the currently highlighted preset. For shared presets, only document administrators can delete.

Export Local Presets - Exports all your local (personal) presets as a library file. Useful for transferring your presets to another computer or backing them up.

Export Shared Presets - Exports all shared team presets as a library file. Useful for backing up team presets or transferring them between organizations.

Import Presets - Imports a preset library file, adding all presets from that library to your current library.

Export Single Preset - Exports only the currently selected preset as a standalone file. Useful for sharing individual presets with colleagues.

Import Single Preset - Imports a single preset file into your library.

Export Usage Report - Generates a CSV file showing team preset usage statistics. This helps teams understand which presets are most commonly used.

Reset All Shared Usage - Resets the team usage statistics for all shared presets. Only available to document administrators.

Note: Some functions (deleting shared presets, resetting team usage) are restricted to document administrators. Administrator privileges are explained in Section 4.4 (Settings) and detailed preset management is covered in Section 5 (Working with Presets).

4.3.2 Preset Tables

The Presets tab displays two tables:

Shared Presets Read-only presets from your team library. These are presets created and maintained by your team's document administrator for everyone to use.

Local Presets Your personal presets that only you can see and use.

Table Columns:

- **Reorder** - Drag handle to reorder presets in the list
- **Preset Name** - The name of the preset
- **Headings** - Number of sections included in the preset
- **Last Used** - Date the preset was last applied
- **My Usage** - Number of times you have used this preset
- **Team Usage** - Total number of times the team has used this preset (shared presets only)
- **Reset** - Resets usage statistics for this preset (administrators only for shared presets)
- **Description** - Editable notes about what this preset is for or when to use it

4.4 Settings Tab

The Settings tab allows you to configure Modulo's behaviour, manage preset modes, and handle licensing.

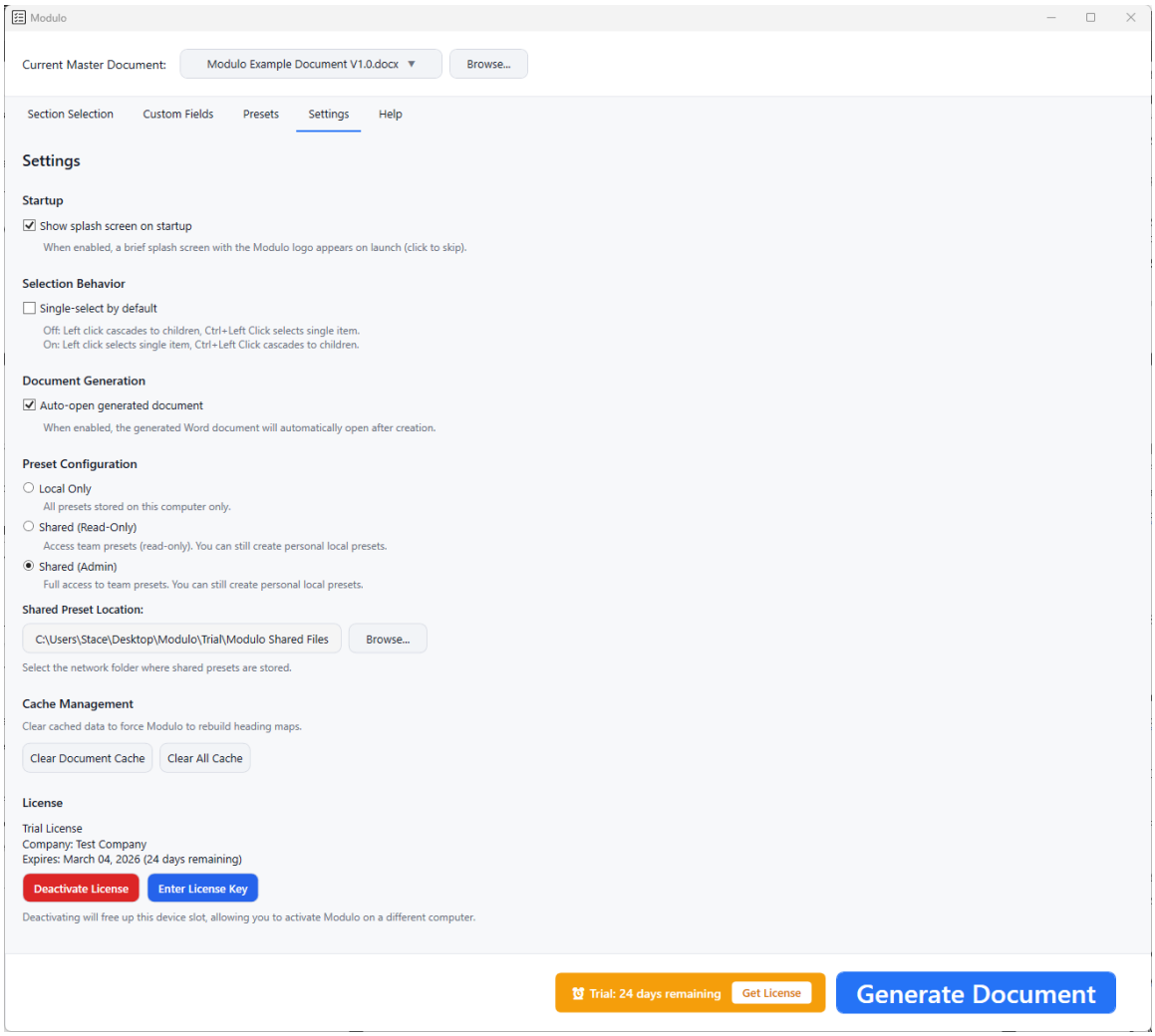


Figure 4-6 Modulo Settings Tab

4.4.1 Startup

Show splash screen on startup - When enabled, a brief splash screen with the Modulo logo appears when you launch Modulo. Click anywhere on the splash screen to skip it and proceed directly to the main interface.

4.4.2 Selection Behaviour

Single-select by default - Controls how clicking sections works:

- **Unchecked (default):** Left click selects a section and all its children. Ctrl+Left Click selects only that single section.
- **Checked:** Left click selects only that single section. Ctrl+Left Click selects the section and all its children.

This setting reverses the default click behaviour to match your preferred workflow.

4.4.3 Document Generation

Auto-open generated document - When enabled, Modulo automatically opens your generated Word document immediately after creation. When disabled, the document is created and saved but not opened automatically.

4.4.4 Preset Configuration

This section controls how presets are stored and shared:

Local Only - All presets are stored on your computer only. No shared team presets are available. Use this mode if you work independently or do not have access to a shared network location.

Shared (Read-Only) - Access team presets in read-only mode. You can load and use shared presets but cannot modify, delete, or create new shared presets. You can still create and manage your own local presets.

Shared (Admin) - Full access to team presets. You can create, modify, delete, and manage shared presets that are available to your entire team. You can also create personal local presets.

Shared Preset Location

Displays the network folder path where shared presets are stored. Click "Browse..." to select a different network location. This folder should be accessible to all team members who need to use shared presets.

Note: Preset modes and shared library setup are explained in detail in Section 5 (Working with Presets).

4.4.5 Cache Management

Modulo caches document structure data to improve performance when loading master documents. If your master document has been updated but Modulo is not detecting the changes correctly, clearing the cache forces Modulo to rebuild the heading map.

Clear Document Cache - Clears the cache for the currently loaded master document only.

Clear All Cache - Clears cached data for all master documents you have previously loaded.

4.4.6 License

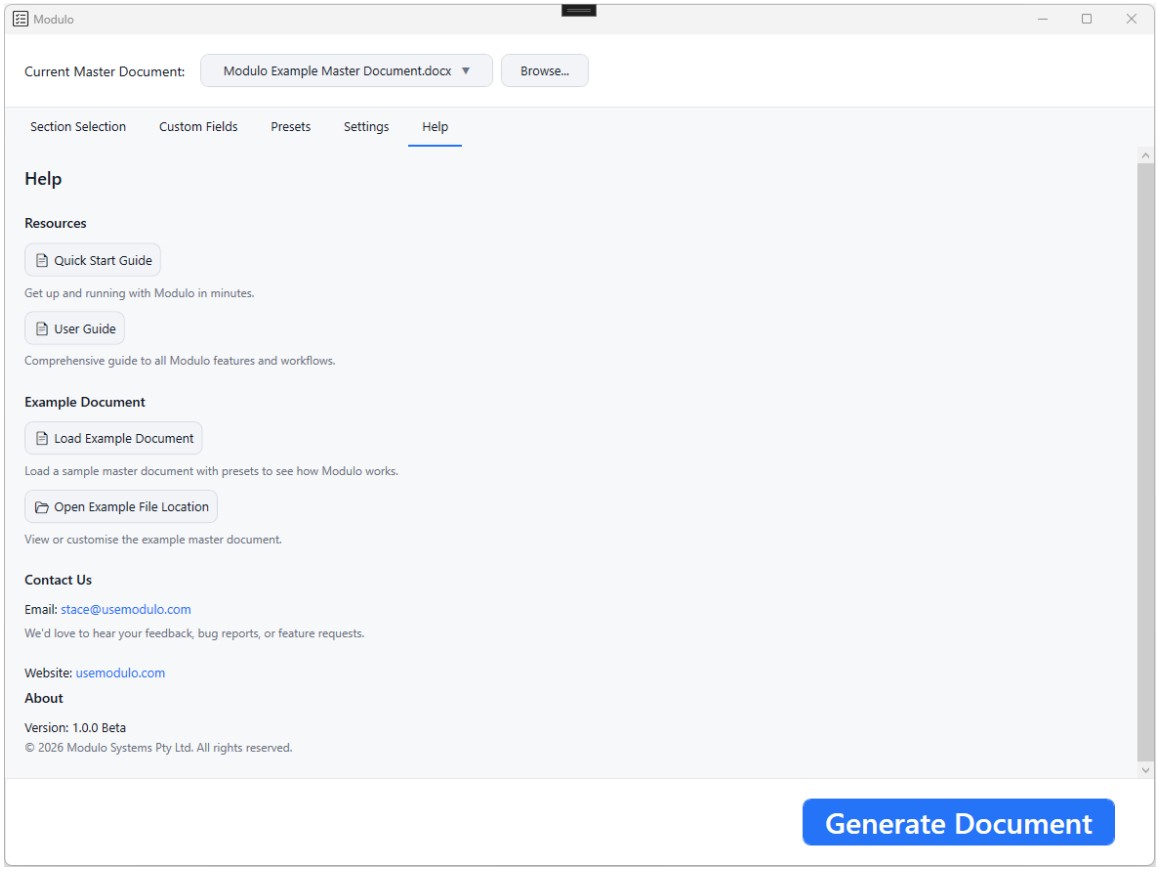
Displays your current license status, including license type (Trial or Paid), company name, and expiration date.

Enter License Key - Opens a dialog to enter a new license key or upgrade from a trial to a paid license.

Deactivate License - Deactivates Modulo on this computer, freeing up a device slot. This allows you to activate Modulo on a different computer. Use this before replacing your computer or if you no longer need Modulo on this device.

4.5 Help Tab

The Help tab provides quick access to documentation, the example document, and contact information.



4.5.1 Resources

Quick Start Guide — Opens the Quick Start Guide PDF, which walks you through installation, activation, and generating your first document.

User Guide — Opens this User Guide PDF for detailed information on all Modulo features.

4.5.2 Example Document

Load Example Document — Loads the included example master document with presets pre-configured. This is the same document offered on first launch. Use it to explore Modulo's features or demonstrate the application to colleagues.

Open Example File Location — Opens the folder containing the example master document. You can use this as a reference when structuring your own master document.

4.5.3 Contact Us

Displays the support email address. Click the link to open your email client with the address pre-filled. We welcome feedback, bug reports, and feature requests.

4.5.4 Website

Link to the Modulo website for the latest news and updates.

4.5.5 About

Displays the current Modulo version number and copyright information.

5 WORKING WITH PRESETS

Presets are the key to using Modulo efficiently. A preset is a saved selection of sections that you can instantly apply instead of manually checking boxes every time you generate a document. This section explains how to create, manage, and share presets across your team.

5.1 Preset Modes: Shared vs Local

Modulo works perfectly well for individual users, but it truly shines when entire teams adopt it. The preset sharing system allows organizations to centralize document knowledge and ensure consistency across all team members.

5.1.1 Understanding Preset Modes

Modulo offers three preset modes, configured in the Settings tab:

Local Only All presets are stored on your computer only. Use this mode if you work independently or do not have access to a shared network location.

Shared (Read-Only) You can access and use team presets created by your document administrator, but you cannot modify or delete them. You can still create and manage your own local presets for personal use.

Shared (Admin) Full control over shared team presets. You can create, modify, and delete shared presets that are available to your entire team. You also have access to your own local presets.

5.1.2 The Team Workflow: Admin and Read-Only Users

The most effective way to use Modulo in a team environment is to designate one person as the **Master Document Administrator**. This person is responsible for:

- Maintaining the master document (adding new sections, updating existing content, fixing formatting)
- Creating and updating shared presets for common document types
- Managing the shared preset library

All other team members operate in **Shared (Read-Only)** mode. They can:

- Load and use any shared preset created by the administrator
- Make temporary adjustments to preset selections for specific projects
- Create their own local presets for personal workflows
- Focus on content rather than document structure

5.1.3 Updating the Master Document

As the document administrator, you can update the master document and shared presets on whatever schedule works for your team:

- **On-demand:** Update the master and presets immediately when changes are needed
- **Scheduled:** Batch all changes and update the master on a regular schedule (e.g., Friday afternoons)

When you update the master document or modify a shared preset, the changes are immediately available to all team members the next time they load the document or preset.

Benefits of Shared Presets

When your team uses shared presets:

- **Consistency:** Everyone generates documents using the same standard section selections
- **Knowledge capture:** Senior staff expertise is embedded in presets and shared with junior staff
- **Onboarding:** New team members can produce proper documents from day one
- **Efficiency:** No one wastes time deciding which sections to include
- **Centralized control:** One person maintains standards; everyone benefits

5.2 Setting Up Shared Preset Libraries

To enable shared presets, you need a network folder accessible to all team members. This section explains how to set up shared presets for the first time and how to link additional computers to the shared library.

5.2.1 Initial Setup: Creating the First Admin

When you first select "Shared (Admin)" mode in the Settings tab, you will be prompted to create an admin password. This password prevents other team members from accidentally changing their mode to Admin and modifying shared presets.

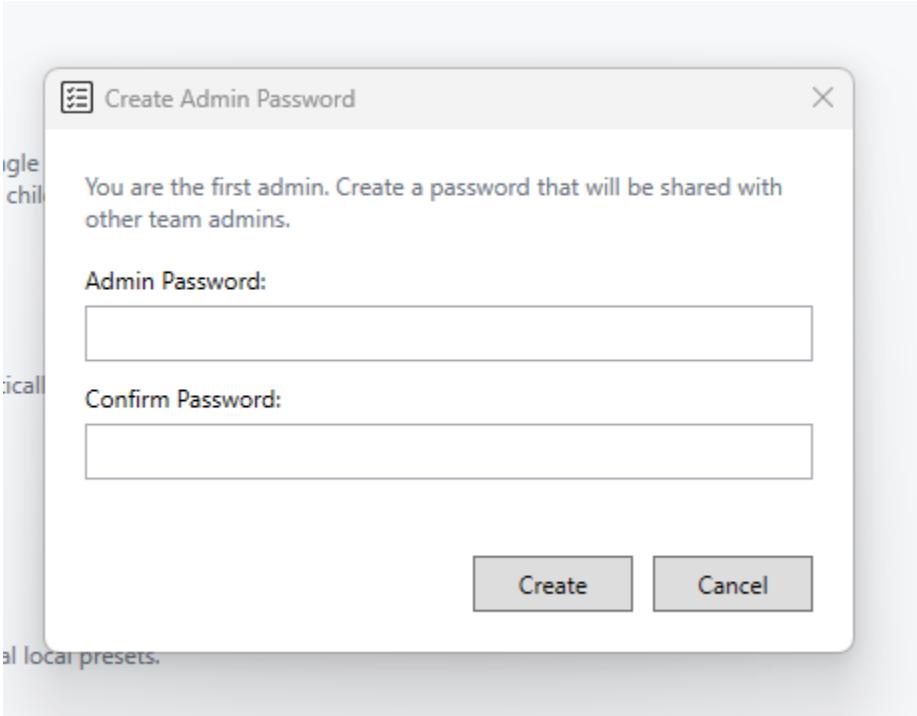


Figure 5-1 Admin Password Dialog

Important notes about the admin password:

- This password is shared among all document administrators on your team
- It provides basic protection against accidental admin access, not security against intentional changes
- If you forget the password, you can reset it by deleting the .moduloadmin file from the shared preset folder, then setting yourself as admin again

5.2.2 Configuring the Shared Preset Location

After creating your admin password (or entering the existing password if you're a subsequent admin):

1. In the Settings tab, ensure "Shared (Admin)" or "Shared (Read-Only)" is selected
2. Click "Browse..." next to "Shared Preset Location"
3. Navigate to the network folder where shared presets will be stored
4. Click OK

For the First Administrator:

When you select a folder location for the first time, Modulo automatically creates a subfolder called "Modulo Shared Files" within your selected location. This is where all shared presets and configuration files are stored.

For example, if you select \\NetworkDrive\TeamFolder\, Modulo creates \\NetworkDrive\TeamFolder\Modulo Shared Files\

For Subsequent Team Members:

When linking to the shared library, you can browse to either:

- The "Modulo Shared Files" subfolder itself, OR
- The parent folder that contains "Modulo Shared Files"

Modulo will automatically detect the correct location in either case. This makes setup easier - team members don't need to navigate to the exact subfolder.

All team members must point to the same network location. Modulo creates/updates shared presets in this folder, and read-only users access them automatically.

5.2.3 Linking a New Computer to the Shared Library

When you set up Modulo on a new computer or reinstall it, you need to link it to your team's shared preset library.

Automatic Prompt (Read-Only Users)

If you are configured as "Shared (Read-Only)" and load a document for the first time, Modulo will automatically prompt you to link to a shared library after processing the document.

Manual Linking

You can also link to a shared library manually:

1. Go to the Presets tab

2. Click "Select Preset Library"
3. In the dialog that opens, click the "Shared Library" radio button
4. Select the library that matches your current master document
5. Click "Select"

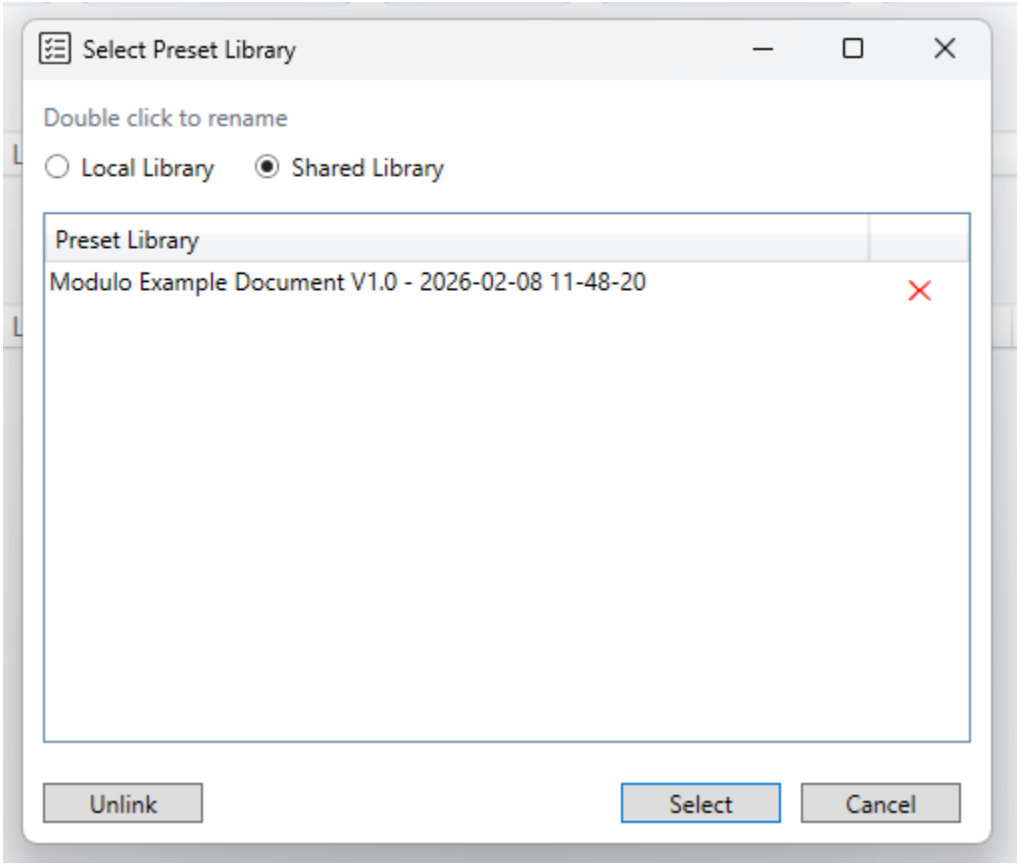


Figure 5-2 Modulo Linking Preset Library

The library list shows the master document name and the date/time the library was created, helping you identify the correct library for your document.

5.2.4 When to Use Each Mode

- **Use Local Only if:** You work independently, have no team collaboration needs, or lack access to a shared network location
- **Use Shared (Read-Only) if:** You are a team member who generates documents using standardized presets created by your administrator
- **Use Shared (Admin) if:** You are responsible for maintaining the master document and managing team presets

5.3 Creating and Managing Presets

Creating effective presets is the key to maximizing Modulo's efficiency. A well-designed preset captures the standard sections for a document type while prompting users to make decisions on sections that require judgment.

5.3.1 Understanding Preset Selection States

When you load a preset, sections are displayed in different colours to indicate their status:

- **Green (Selected by preset):** This section is always included when using this preset
- **Blue (Requires decision):** This section requires human judgment - you must decide whether to include it or not
- **Orange (Position changed):** The heading has been renumbered in the master document since the preset was created
- **Red (Section missing):** The heading no longer exists in the master document

You cannot generate a document until all blue prompted sections are resolved. This is a safety feature that ensures users actively think about what they're including rather than blindly accepting defaults.

5.3.2 Creating a New Preset

Step 1: Select Your Standard Sections

Start by checking the boxes next to all sections that should always be included for this document type. These will appear in green when the preset is loaded.

Step 2: Add Prompted Sections

For sections that sometimes apply but require judgment, right-click the section instead of checking it. The section will turn blue, indicating it requires a decision when the preset is used.

For example, in a geotechnical report, you might always include "Site Description" (checked) but prompt for "Rock Coring" (right-clicked) since it only applies to some projects.

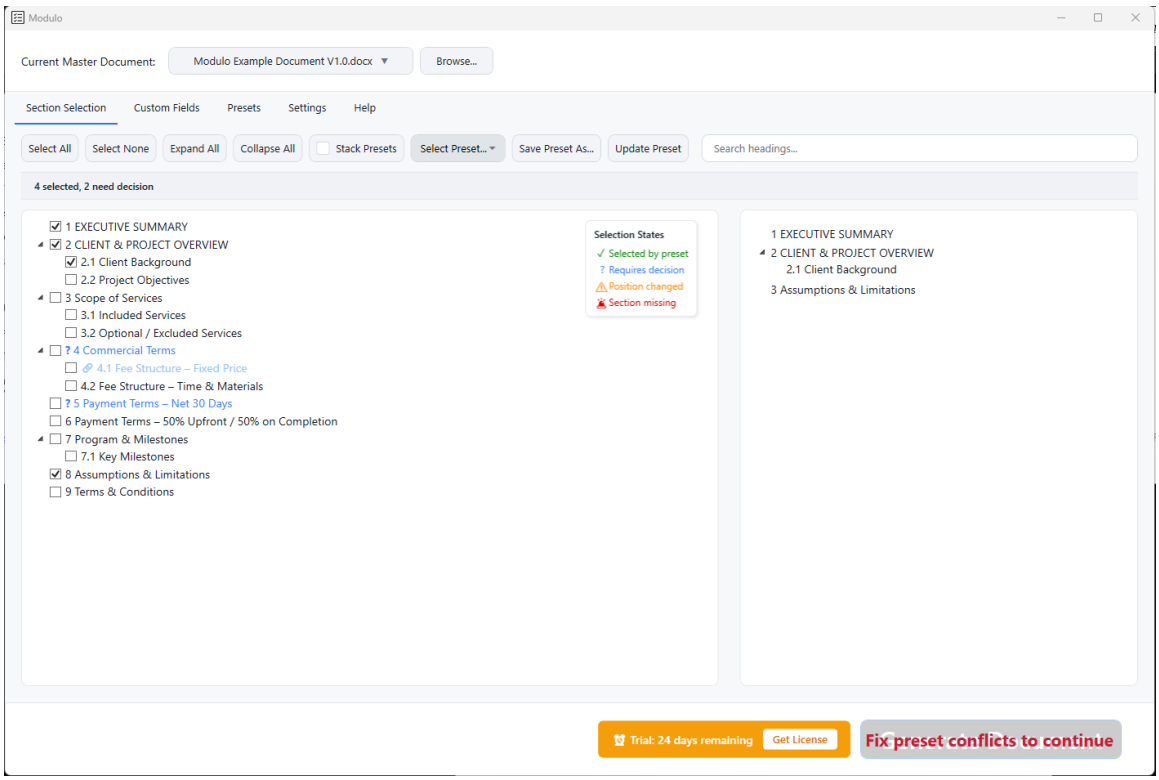


Figure 5-3 Selecting Sections for New Preset

Step 3: Link Related Sections (Optional)

You can link sections so that when a user selects one section, related sections are automatically ticked. This is useful for sections that always go together.

To create a link:

1. Hold Ctrl and right-click the parent section
2. Continue holding Ctrl
3. Right-click or left-click each section you want to link to the parent
4. Release Ctrl

Modulo displays a blue line connecting linked sections. When a user loads this preset and ticks the parent section, all linked sections automatically tick.

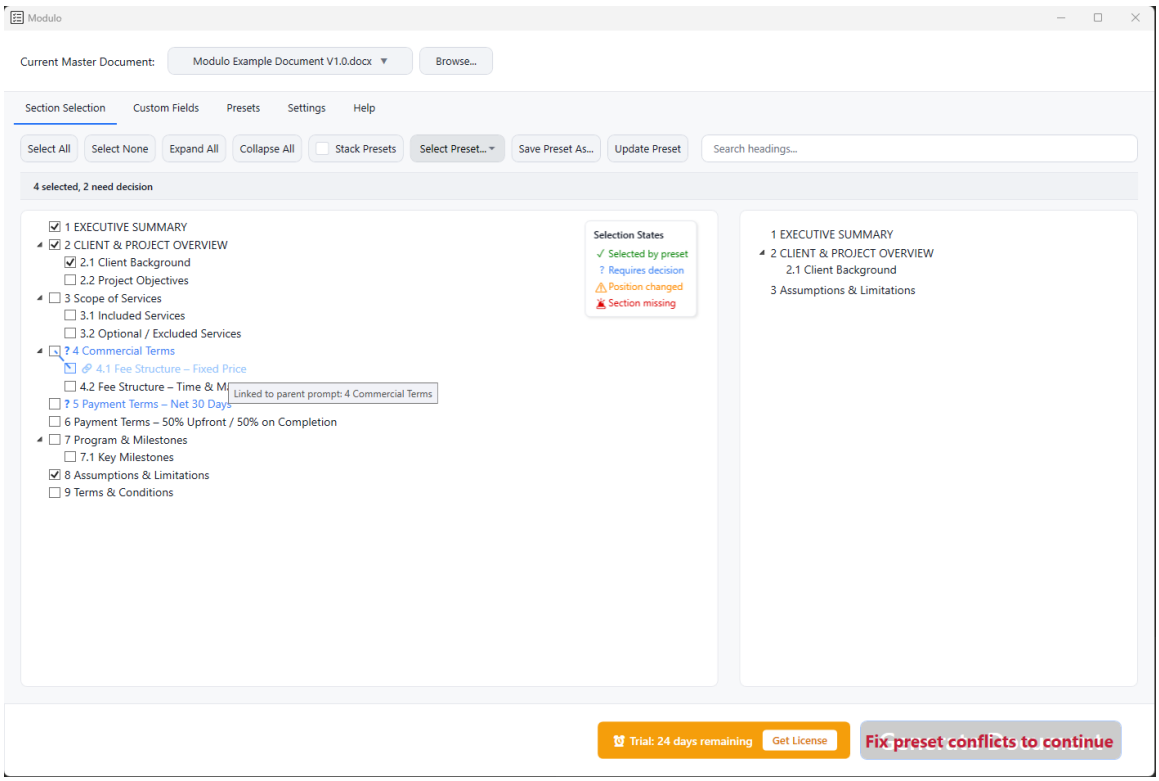


Figure 5-4 Example of a Linked Section

Step 4: Save the Preset

Once you have configured all your sections, click "Save Preset As..."

Choose whether to save as:

- **Local:** Only you can access this preset
- **Shared:** All team members can access this preset (Admin only)

Enter a descriptive name for the preset and optionally add a description explaining when to use it.

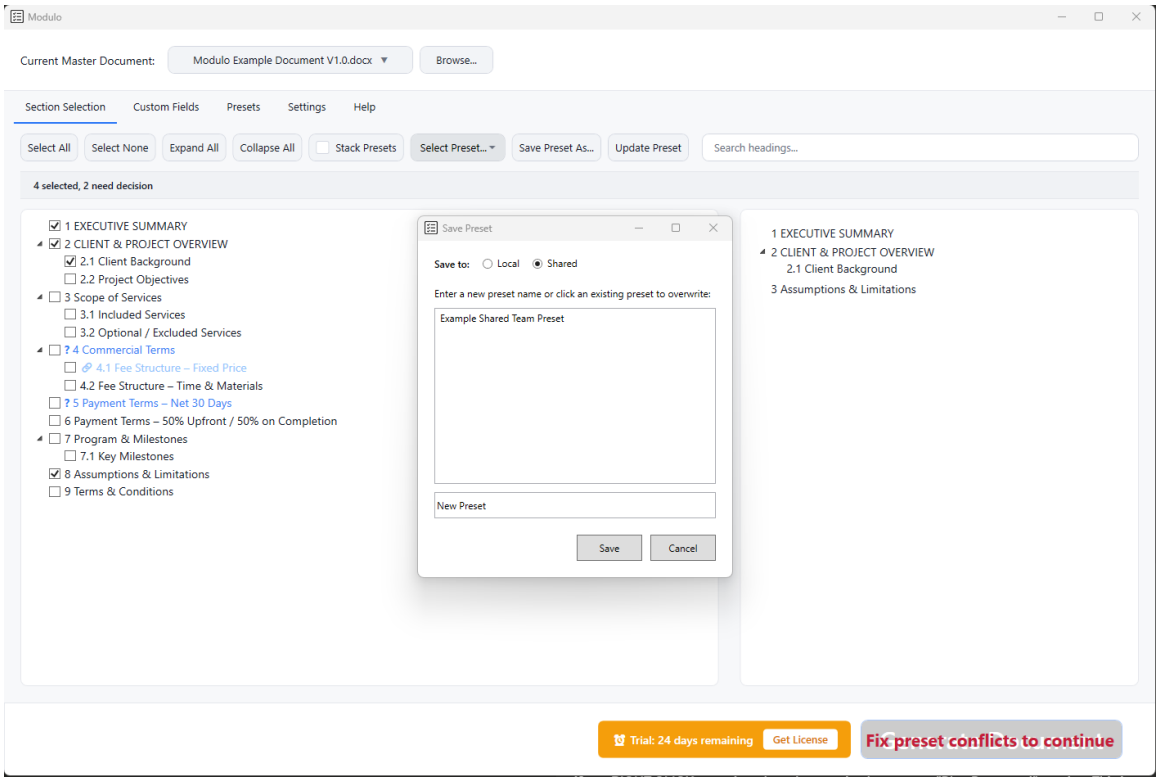


Figure 5-5 Saving the Preset

5.3.3 Loading a Preset

After saving, your preset appears in the "Select Preset..." dropdown. When you load it, all your configured sections are applied instantly:

- Standard sections are checked (green)
- Prompted sections require your decision (blue)
- Linked sections will auto-tick when their parent is selected

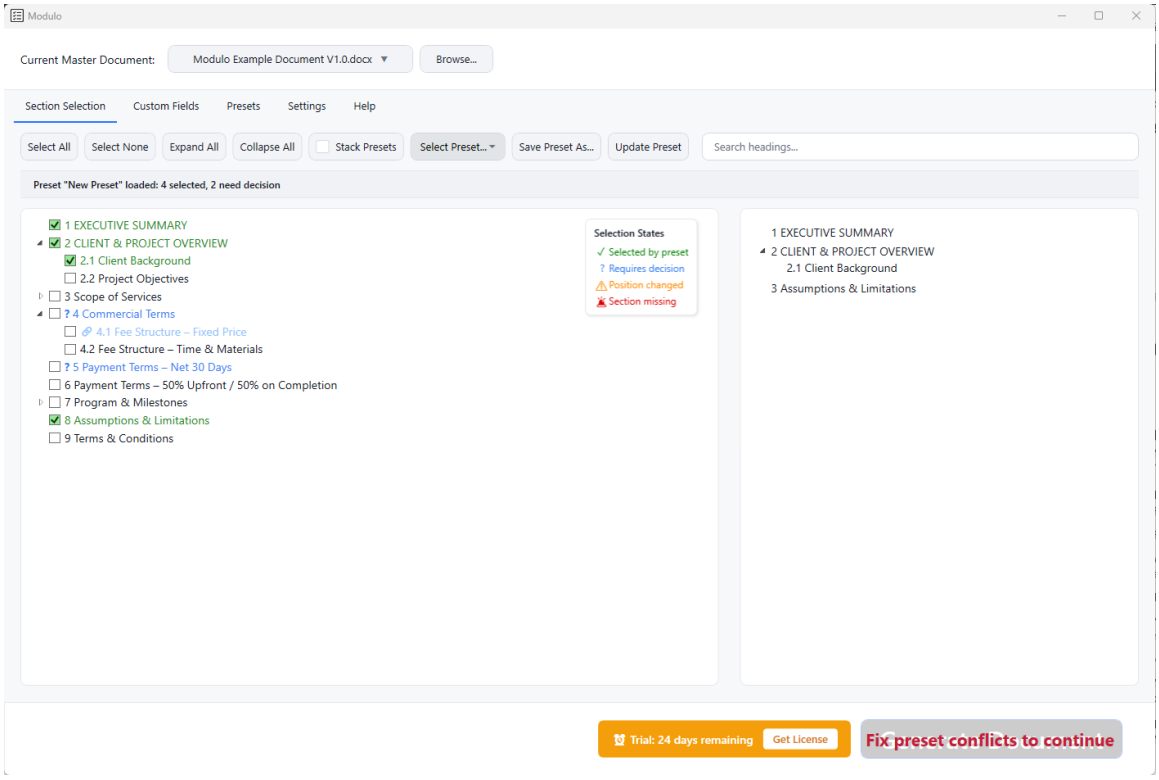


Figure 5-6 A Loaded Preset

5.3.4 Updating an Existing Preset

To modify a preset:

1. Load the preset using the "Select Preset..." dropdown
2. Make your changes (add sections, remove sections, change prompted states, modify links)
3. Click "Update Preset"

The preset is immediately updated for all users (if shared) or for you (if local).

5.3.5 Best Practices for Preset Design

- **Name presets clearly:** Use names that describe the document type (e.g., "Site Investigation - Soil Only" rather than "Preset 1")
- **Use prompted sections strategically:** Prompt for sections that require project-specific judgment, not sections that are always optional
- **Group related presets:** If you have multiple variations of a document type, use consistent naming (e.g., "Quote - Residential", "Quote - Commercial", "Quote - Government")
- **Add descriptions:** Use the description field to explain when to use each preset and what makes it different from similar presets
- **Review and update after master changes:** Whenever you add, remove, or modify sections in your master document, review all affected presets to ensure they still select the correct sections. The next section explains how Modulo detects and handles these changes, including automatic renumbering detection.

5.4 Handling Master Document Changes: Renumbering and Missing Headings

When you modify your master document by adding, removing, or renaming sections, Modulo automatically detects these changes and helps you update your presets accordingly.

5.4.1 Automatic Change Detection

Modulo detects master document changes:

- When you launch Modulo
- When you click "Generate Document"
- When you load a preset

If changes are detected, Modulo prompts you to reload the master document with the latest version before loading your preset.

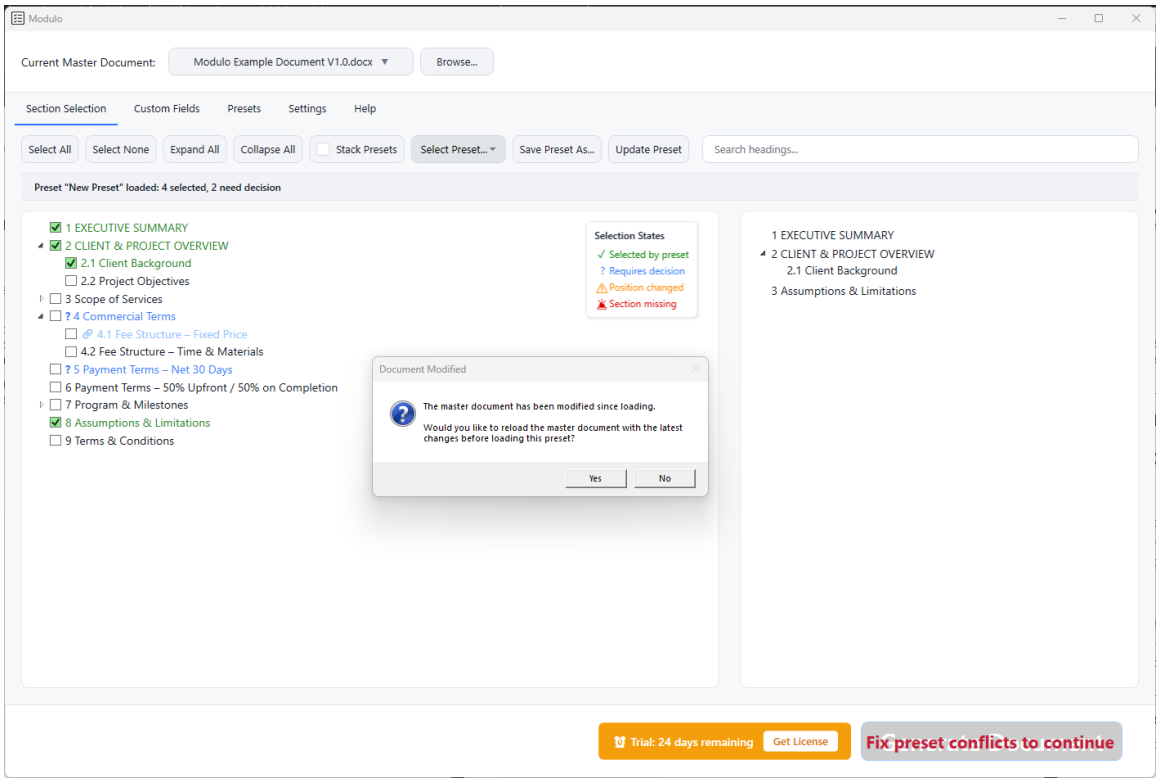


Figure 5-7 Document Modified Dialog

5.4.2 Renumbered Headings (Orange/Yellow)

When you insert a new section into your master document, all subsequent sections are renumbered. For example, if you add "4 INSERTING A NEW HEADING" to a document that previously had sections numbered 4, 5, 6, the old section 4 becomes section 5, old section 5 becomes section 6, and so on.

Modulo detects this renumbering and attempts to automatically match the old preset selections to the new section numbers. Renumbered sections are displayed in orange (or yellow with blue background if prompted).

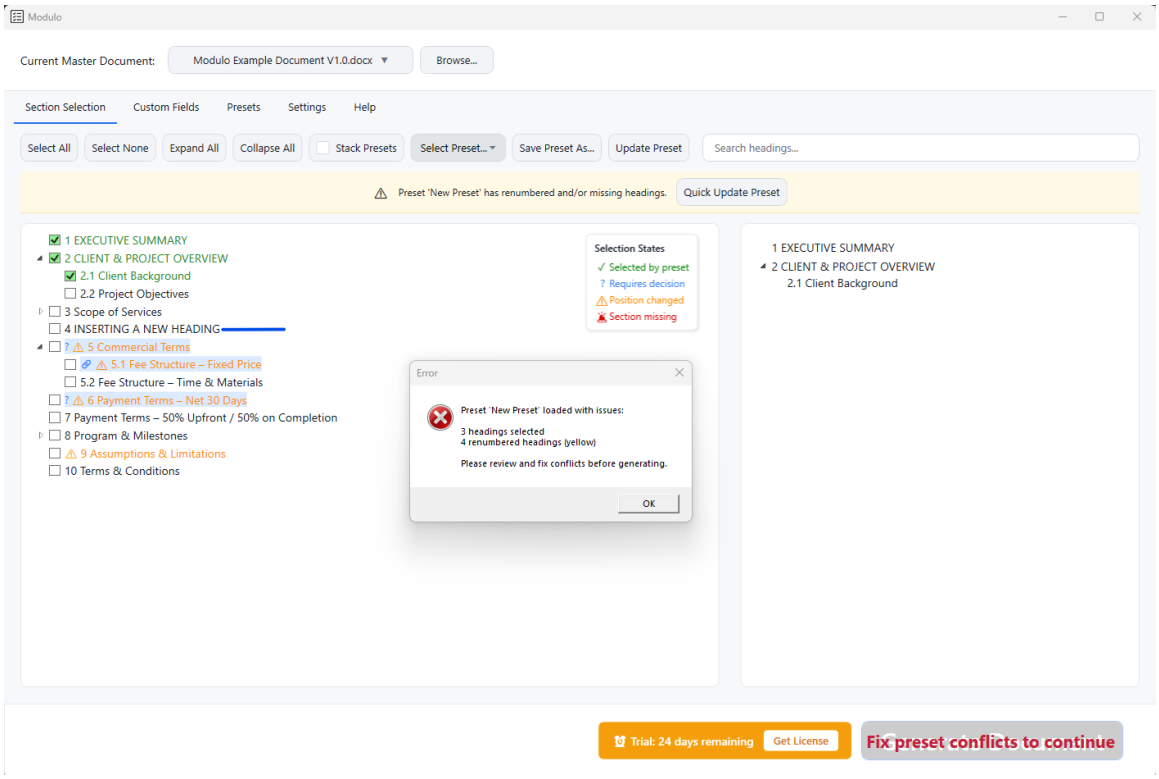


Figure 5-8 Renumbering Detected Error Dialog

Important: While Modulo's matching algorithm is accurate for simple renumbering, large-scale document restructuring can cause incorrect matches. Always review all orange headings to verify Modulo matched them correctly before using Quick Update Preset.

5.4.3 Numbering Style Compatibility

Modulo's renumbering detection works with any heading numbering style, including:

- Standard numbers (1, 2, 3)
- Roman numerals (I, II, III or i, ii, iii)
- Letters (A, B, C or a, b, c)
- Letters with parentheses (a), b), c))
- Custom numbering formats defined in your master document

Regardless of how your headings are numbered, Modulo tracks the logical position and structure of sections rather than the literal numbering text. This means renumbering detection works reliably even if you use different numbering styles for different heading levels (e.g., "I" for level 1, "A" for level 2, "1" for level 3).

5.4.4 Quick Update Preset

If you are satisfied with Modulo's automatic matching (or have manually corrected any errors), you can use the "Quick Update Preset" feature to save the updated heading mappings.

Click the "Quick Update Preset" link in the yellow banner at the top of the interface. A dialog appears explaining what will happen:

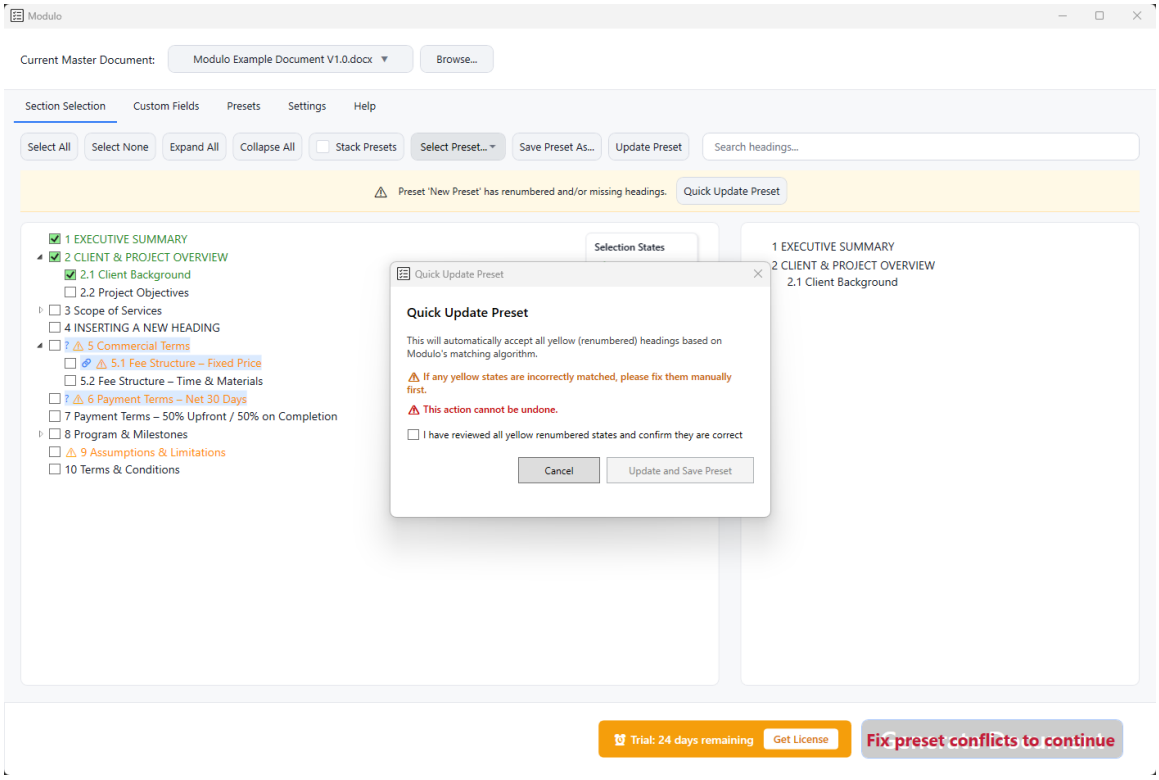


Figure 5-9 Quick Update Preset Dialog

Check the confirmation box and click "Update and Save Preset". Modulo automatically remaps all renumbered headings and saves the updated preset.

Important: This action cannot be undone. If any orange headings are incorrectly matched, fix them manually before using Quick Update.

If the preset is shared and you are an administrator, the updated preset is immediately available to all team members.

5.4.5 After Quick Update

When you reload the preset, all previously orange headings now appear in their correct state (green for selected, blue for prompted):

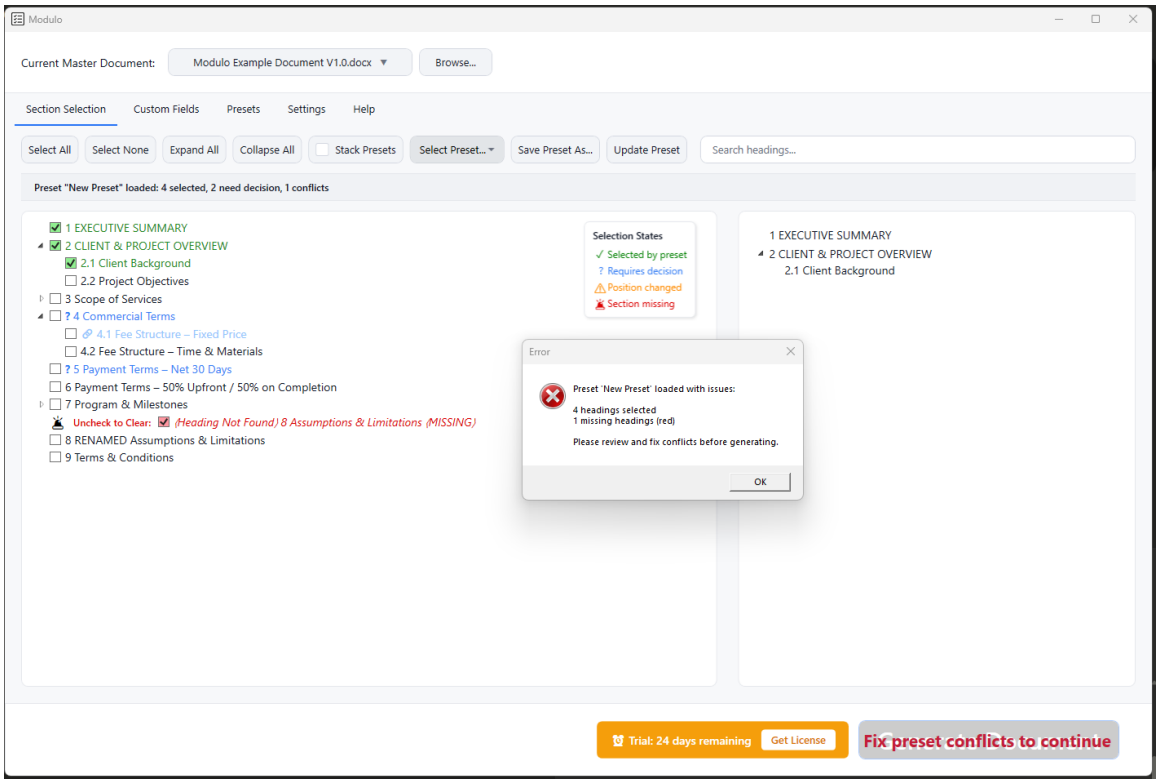


Figure 5-10 All Headings Corrected After Quick Update

5.4.6 Missing or Renamed Headings (Red)

If you rename or delete a heading that was included in a preset, Modulo displays it in red to indicate the section no longer exists in the master document.

Red headings appear:

- At the top of the heading list, OR
- Inline where Modulo estimates the heading should have been (if it can determine the approximate position)

Red headings with a blue background indicate they were prompted sections in the original preset.

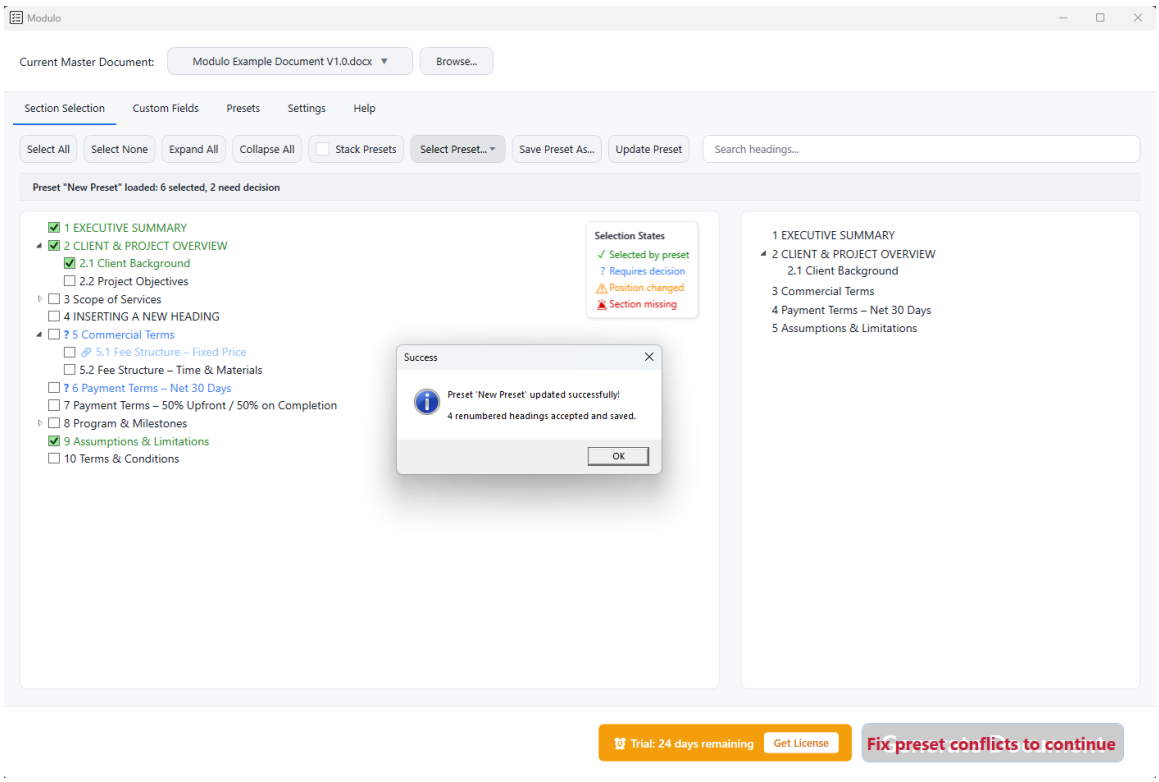


Figure 5-11 Missing heading shown in red with inline message and error dialog

5.4.7 Fixing Missing Headings

You have two options for resolving missing headings:

Option 1: Remove the heading from the preset

1. Click the red heading - this marks it for removal
2. Click "Update Preset" to save the change
3. The heading is removed from the preset

Option 2: Replace with the renamed heading If you renamed the heading rather than deleting it:

1. Find the new name in the section list
2. Select it (check the box or right-click to prompt)
3. Click the red heading to mark it for removal
4. Click "Update Preset"
5. The preset now references the new heading name instead

5.4.8 Best Practices

- **Review before Quick Update:** Always verify orange headings are correctly matched before using Quick Update Preset
- **Update all affected presets:** If you make major changes to your master document, review and update all presets that reference the changed sections
- **Communicate changes:** If you are an administrator updating shared presets, inform your team about significant preset changes
- **Test after updating:** Load the updated preset and verify the selections are correct before generating a document

6 CUSTOM FIELD FORMULAS

Modulo's Custom Fields support formulas that can perform calculations automatically. This chapter explains the formula syntax and provides examples of common use cases.

6.1 Formula Syntax Basics

Formulas are created using the format: <<FIELDNAME=FORMULA>>

For example: <<$TOTAL=RATE*HOURS>>

When you enter values for RATE and HOURS, Modulo automatically calculates TOTAL and displays the result.

Field References

You can reference other fields in your formulas by name. For example, if you have fields named RATE, HOURS, and DISCOUNT, you can write:

<<$SUBTOTAL=RATE*HOURS>> <<$TOTAL=SUBTOTAL*(1-DISCOUNT)>>

Modulo automatically resolves field references and calculates results in the correct order.

6.2 Arithmetic Operators

Modulo supports standard mathematical operators:

- **Addition:** <<TOTAL=A+B>>
- **Subtraction:** <<DIFFERENCE=A-B>>
- **Multiplication:** <<PRODUCT=A*B>>
- **Division:** <<QUOTIENT=A/B>>

Parentheses for Order of Operations

Use parentheses to control calculation order:

<<$TOTAL=(RATE*HOURS)+(MATERIALS*1.15)>>
<<$AVERAGE=(SCORE1+SCORE2+SCORE3)/3>>

Decimals in Formulas

You can include decimal values directly in formulas:

<<$HALVED=TOTAL*0.5>> <<$TENOFF=PRICE*0.9>> <<$TAX=SUBTOTAL*0.1>>

6.3 Mathematical Functions

Modulo supports several mathematical functions:

Power and Roots

- Pow(base, exponent) - Raises base to the power of exponent
  - <<SQUARED=Pow(VALUE,2)>>
  - <<CUBED=Pow(VALUE,3)>>
  - <<CUSTOM=Pow(BASE,EXPONENT)>>
- Sqrt(value) - Square root
  - <<SQUAREROOT=Sqrt(VALUE)>>
  - <<ROOTOFSUM=Sqrt(A+B)>>

Rounding and Precision

- Round(value, decimals) - Rounds to specified decimal places
  - <<ROUNDED=Round(VALUE,2)>>
- Ceiling(value) - Rounds up to nearest integer
  - <<CEILINGVAL=Ceiling(VALUE)>>
- Floor(value) - Rounds down to nearest integer
  - <<FLOORVAL=Floor(VALUE)>>

Absolute Value

- Abs(value) - Returns absolute value
  - <<ABSOLUTEVAL=Abs(VALUE)>>

Min/Max

- Max(a, b) - Returns larger value
  - <<MAXVAL=Max(A,B)>>
- Min(a, b) - Returns smaller value
  - <<MINVAL=Min(A,B)>>

Logarithms

- Ln(value) - Natural logarithm (base e)
  - <<LNVAL=Ln(VALUE)>>
- Log(value, base) - Logarithm with custom base
  - <<LOG2VAL=Log(VALUE, 2)>>
  - <<LOGCUSTOMVAL=Log(VALUE, BASE)>>
- Log10(value) - Base-10 logarithm
  - <<LOG10VAL=Log10(VALUE)>>

6.4 Common Formula Examples

Financial Calculations

Markup and profit:

<<$MARKUP=COST*1.25>>

<<$PROFIT=PRICE-COST>>

<<%MARGIN=(PRICE-COST)/PRICE>>

Net pay with tax:

<<$NETPAY=SALARY-(SALARY*TAXRATE)>>

Loan payments:

<<$MONTHLYPAY=LOANAMOUNT/MONTHS>>

Return on investment:

<<%ROI=(REVENUE-COST)/COST>>

Chained Calculations

You can reference calculated fields in other formulas:

<<$BASE=HOURS*RATE>>

<<$WITHTAX=BASE*1.1>>

<<$FINAL=WITHTAX+FEES>>

Modulo calculates these in order: BASE first, then WITHTAX (using BASE's result), then FINAL (using WITHTAX's result).

Complex Nested Formulas

<<$COMPLEXCALC=((RATE*HOURS)*1.1)+((MATERIALS*1.15)-DISCOUNT)>>

<<$PYTHAGOREAN=Sqrt(Pow(SIDEA,2)+Pow(SIDEB,2))>>

<<$DISTANCE=Sqrt(Pow(X2-X1,2)+Pow(Y2-Y1,2))>>

6.5 Formula Errors and Warnings

Modulo displays warnings when formulas contain errors. Common error causes:

Circular References

A circular reference occurs when formulas reference each other in a loop:

<<$VALUEA=VALUEB*2>>

<<$VALUEB=VALUEA*2>>

This creates an infinite loop - VALUEA depends on VALUEB, but VALUEB depends on VALUEA. Modulo cannot resolve this and will display an error.

Self-Referencing

A formula that references itself:

<<$INFINITE=INFINITE+1>>

This is also a circular reference and will produce an error.

Missing Field References

If a formula references a field that does not exist or is not currently displayed (because its section is not selected), the formula will produce an error.

Division by Zero

Formulas that attempt to divide by zero will produce an error:

<<RESULT=VALUE/0>>

Invalid Function Arguments

Some functions require specific types of arguments. For example, Sqrt() cannot calculate the square root of a negative number in real mathematics, which may produce an error depending on your input values.

6.6 Testing Your Formulas

When creating complex formulas:

1. Start simple and build complexity gradually
2. Use the "Breakdown" column in Calculated Fields to see how Modulo evaluated your formula
3. Test with different input values to ensure the formula works correctly
4. Check for error messages before generating your document

If a formula does not work as expected, try simplifying it or breaking it into multiple chained calculations.

7 TROUBLESHOOTING

Modulo is currently in beta testing. While it has been tested extensively in our office environment, you may encounter issues we haven't seen yet. This section covers basic troubleshooting steps and how to report problems.

7.1 Basic Troubleshooting Steps

7.1.1 Clear Document Cache

If Modulo is not detecting changes to your master document or behaving unexpectedly:

1. Go to the Settings tab
2. Click "Clear Document Cache" (for current document) or "Clear All Cache" (for all documents)
3. Reload your master document

This forces Modulo to rebuild its internal map of your document structure.

7.1.2 Isolate Problematic Sections

If document generation fails or produces unexpected results:

1. Use "Select None" to clear all selections
2. Select just a few sections and try generating
3. Gradually add more sections to identify which section causes the problem
4. Once identified, check that section in your master document for:
    - Corrupted tables
    - Problematic images
    - Unusual formatting

7.2 Getting Help

If you encounter issues you cannot resolve, please contact us at **stace@usemodulo.com** with:

- **Description of the problem:** What happened and what you expected to happen
- **Screenshots:** Capture any error messages or unexpected behavior
- **Your master document:** If possible, send us the document (we understand if confidentiality prevents this)
- **Steps to reproduce:** What you were doing when the problem occurred

Your feedback helps us improve Modulo for everyone.

8 THANK YOU

Thank you for trying Modulo. This software was built to solve a real problem we face every day in our engineering practice, and we hope it makes your document workflows faster and more consistent.

Modulo is in active development, and your feedback is invaluable. If you have suggestions, feature requests, or just want to share how Modulo has improved your workflow, we'd love to hear from you.

For questions, support, or feedback: **stace@usemodulo.com**

We're excited to see how you use Modulo in your practice.

— Stace Puts
Creator, Modulo